Streamlining Ticket Assignment for Efficient Support Operations

1. Ideation Phase

🔷 1. Problem Identification

The current support system faces several issues:

- Manual ticket assignment
- Incorrect assignment to teams or agents
- Delays in ticket handling
- High-priority tickets not addressed on time

Impact:

- Missed SLA (Service Level Agreements)
- Uneven workload distribution
- Reduced customer satisfaction

🔷 2. Goal Definition

The main objectives are:

- Automate ticket assignment
- Assign tickets to the correct team/agent
- Reduce response and resolution time
- Ensure SLA compliance
- **Core Goal:**
  Assign the right ticket to the right person at the right time

🔷 Ideas to Solve

- Use rules → assign based on category (like network, software)
- Use skills → assign to experts
- Share work equally → distribute tickets among team
- Use priority → urgent tickets first

Defining the Problem

🔷 Current Situation

In support operations, tickets are usually assigned **manually** to agents or teams.

🔷 Problems Faced

- Tickets are assigned to the **wrong person or team**
- **Delay** in assigning tickets
- **High-priority tickets** are not handled quickly
- Some agents get **too many tickets**, others get fewer
- **Human errors** happen during assignment

🔷 Impact

- Slow response time
- Missed SLA (Service Level Agreement)
- Increased workload stress
- Poor customer satisfaction

Empathize & Discover

🔷 1. Empathize (Understand Users)

In this step, we understand the people involved in the system:

Support Agents

- Receive too many or wrong tickets
- Feel stressed due to workload
- Waste time reassigning tickets

Support Managers

- Struggle to monitor ticket distribution
- Face SLA issues
- Need better control over assignment

Customers

- Experience delays in issue resolution
- Get frustrated when tickets are reassigned
- Expect quick and correct support

🔷 2. Discover (Find the Real Issues)

We identify the root causes:

- No proper system for automatic assignment
- Lack of skill-based matching
- No priority handling system
- Manual process causes delays and errors
- Poor visibility of agent workload

🔷 3. Methods Used

To understand the problem better:

- Observing how tickets are assigned
- Talking to support agents/managers
- Analyzing past ticket data
- Identifying common delays and errors

🔷 What is Requirement Analysis?

It means understanding **what the system needs to do** to solve the problem.

🔷 1. Functional Requirements (What system should do)

- Automatically assign tickets
- Assign tickets to the **right team or agent**
- Use **category** (network, software, etc.)
- Use **agent skills** for correct assignment

System Requirements

- Use ServiceNow platform
- Use Assignment Rules / Flow Designer
- Store agent skills
- Maintain ticket data

Design Phase

Project: *Streamlining Ticket Assignment for Efficient Support Operations*

🔷 1. What is Design Phase?

The design phase means **planning how the system will work** before building it.

🔷 2. System Architecture (How system is structured)

Basic Flow:

→ System checks details (category, priority)
→ Matches with agent skills
→ Assigns ticket automatically

🔷 3. Components of the System

Ticket Module

- Stores ticket details (issue, category, priority)

Assignment Engine

- Applies rules to assign tickets
- Matches skills and availability

Agent Database

- Stores agent skills and workload

Notification System

- Sends alerts to assigned agents

Reporting Module

- Tracks performance and SLA

🔷 4. Design Approach

- Rule-based assignment (category, priority)
- Skill-based routing (expert matching)
- Workload balancing (equal distribution)

🔷 5. Workflow Design

1. Ticket is created
2. System reads ticket details

🔷 6. Tools Used

- ServiceNow Platform
- Assignment Rules
- Flow Designer / Business Rules

🔷 7. Output of Design Phase

- System workflow
- Module structure
- Assignment logic design
- Clear plan for implementation

Project Planning Phase

The project planning phase focuses on organizing how the system will be developed and implemented in an efficient and structured manner. In this phase, the overall scope of the project is clearly defined, including the goal of automating ticket assignment to improve accuracy, reduce delays, and enhance support operations.

The work is divided into smaller tasks such as requirement analysis, system design, development, testing, and deployment. A proper timeline is prepared to ensure that each stage of the project is completed within the given duration. Resources such as the ServiceNow platform, development tools, and team members are identified and allocated based on the project needs.

Roles and responsibilities are also planned during this phase. For example, developers focus on implementing assignment rules and workflows, while testers ensure that the system works correctly without errors. Risk factors, such as incorrect data or system limitations, are considered in advance, and possible solutions are planned to avoid delays.

Project Development Phase

The project development phase focuses on building the actual system based on the design and planning completed earlier. In this stage, the ticket assignment solution is implemented using the ServiceNow platform, where all the required modules and functionalities are created step by step. The development begins with configuring the ticket module to capture important details such as category, priority, and description of the issue.

Once the ticket structure is ready, assignment rules are developed to automate the process of assigning tickets to the appropriate teams or agents. These rules are designed based on factors like ticket category, priority level, and agent skills. In

addition to this, workflows are created using tools such as Flow Designer and Business Rules to ensure that the ticket moves smoothly through different stages, from creation to resolution.

Project Documentation Phase

The project documentation phase focuses on clearly recording all the details related to the system that has been developed. In this stage, every part of the project—from the initial problem statement to the final implementation—is documented in an organized manner. This includes explanations of the requirements, system design, development process, and the technologies used during the project.

The documentation also describes how the ticket assignment system works, including the flow of ticket creation, automatic assignment based on rules and skills, and the resolution process. Important components such as assignment rules, workflows, and configurations in the ServiceNow platform are explained so that anyone reading the document can easily understand the system.

Project Demonstration Phase

The project demonstration phase is the stage where the completed system is presented to others to show how it works in real time. In this phase, the focus is on clearly explaining the purpose of the project and demonstrating how the ticket assignment process has been improved through automation. The demonstration usually begins with a brief introduction to the problem, followed by an overview of the solution developed using the ServiceNow platform.

During the demonstration, the working of the system is shown step by step. A sample ticket is created, and the system automatically assigns it to the appropriate agent based on predefined rules such as category, priority, and skill set. The flow of the ticket from creation to resolution is displayed to highlight how the process is faster and more accurate compared to manual assignment. Notifications, status updates, and workload distribution can also be demonstrated to give a complete understanding of the system.

Conclusion

The project successfully addresses the challenges involved in manual ticket assignment by introducing an automated and structured approach to handling support requests. Through the use of rule-based and skill-based assignment methods, the system ensures that tickets are directed to the most appropriate agents without unnecessary delays. This not only reduces manual effort but also improves the accuracy and speed of the overall support process.